

CO.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document a Colorado owner-builder is likely to meet — what each one is, when you need it, and which office it comes from.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Colorado adopts no statewide residential building code: each county and each municipality decides for itself whether to require a building permit and which code edition to enforce, and a few counties require no building permit at all. Electrical and plumbing run on a separate, statewide track. Confirm every item with the office that will actually issue it before you rely on it. Colorado names most of its permit documents rather than numbering them, so this index prints names as published. Your local building department and public health agency each publish packets of their own.

Documents a Colorado owner-builder will actually encounter

Document	What it is and when you need it	Where it comes from
Electrical Permit Application	The state electrical permit, bought before any wiring starts (C.R.S. 12-115-120(2)(b)). The Division publishes a homeowner form set alongside the contractor one, and a homeowner is a qualified applicant by statute. Buying online is " <i>processed immediately upon payment</i> "; a hard copy " <i>may be delayed up to 7 business days.</i> " When: before the first wire.	DPO — dpo.colorado.gov → Electrical & Plumbing Permits
Plumbing Permit Application	The state plumbing permit, bought before any plumbing starts (12-155-120(1)(c)(I)). For a residential job the application asks for a fixture count — traps, water hammer arrestors, backflow preventers, water heaters, fuel gas outlets and regulators — so count them off your plans first.	DPO — same page
Gas Piping Permit Application	Separate from the plumbing permit. Fuel gas piping is plumbing-board work under its own adopted code, and on a propane build it is easy to forget until an inspector asks. When: before any gas piping is installed.	DPO — same page
Homeowner's Guide for Electrical Installations · Homeowner's Guide for Plumbing and Gas Piping Installations	Two plain-language guides the Division publishes for homeowners doing their own work — the closest thing Colorado has to an official owner-builder handbook for the trades, and free. The same page carries a Requirements for Well Wiring handout, which almost every rural owner-builder needs and almost no general guide covers.	DPO — Permit and Inspections Forms

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Electrical / Plumbing Inspection Map and Inspector Contact List	How you find the human being who will inspect your house — the Division will not schedule for you. There is also a Remote Video Inspection Waiver for occupied residential work, worth asking about on a parcel where an inspector's drive time runs to hours. When: the day you buy the permit.	DPO — Permit and Inspections Forms
Certificate of approval (electrical; plumbing; gas)	Not filed — received and kept. The inspector issues it when work passes (12-115-120(3)(a); 12-155-120(2)(a)). On the electrical side it is also your evidence that the work <i>was inspected</i> — the condition your homeowner exemption depends on (12-115-116(2)).	Issued by your inspector
Residential well permit application	Filed with DWR through its Applications eForms Dashboard; DWR takes applications by email and fees online. When: first — " <i>review of complete applications may take up to 49 days,</i> " before a driller is scheduled. Read the Beginner's Guide to Well Permits first.	DWR — dwr.colorado.gov , Well Permitting
Well construction report · pump installation report	Filed with DWR by your driller and pump installer, not by you — but they belong in your file, and a lender or buyer will ask. DWR's Well Permit Search and Map Viewer let you read what neighboring permits allow before you buy land.	Filed by the driller; at DWR
OWTS (septic) permit application	There is no state form. Local board of health rules must provide the " <i>procedures by which a person may apply</i> " and set what the application must contain (C.R.S. 25-10-106(1)(a)), so the packet is your county's or health district's own. When: after the site evaluation and soil work, before the system is built — and the system may not be used until a final inspection passes (25-10-106(1)(h)).	Your local public health agency
Local building permit application and submittal checklist	Only where your jurisdiction has adopted a building code; the local list governs. Colorado checklists typically ask for house plans, a soils report, a foundation plan, a site plan, an energy calculation, and Manual J and D load calculations — with the soils report and foundation plans carrying an original Colorado engineer's or architect's stamp.	Your building department

Documents a Colorado owner-builder will actually encounter

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Local homeowner / owner-builder permit application	Where one exists it is a local creation with local conditions — there is no state version. Denver requires a photo ID matching the deed, an exam for the trades, and occupancy " <i>for at least one year after work is complete</i> "; Pikes Peak Regional issues to an owner only for " <i>your primary residence, which you own and reside in.</i> " Ask what your department's version commits you to before you sign (CO.1).	Your building department
Project approval / routing sheet	A Colorado pattern worth expecting: one sheet every interested agency must sign before the permit or the CO issues — and departments commonly require it completed even by an agency that says the job is outside its jurisdiction. Ask early who is on yours: fire district, health, roads, floodplain.	Your building department
Permanent energy certificate	Not filed — posted . Under the 2021 IECC as adopted by Colorado jurisdictions, the builder completes a permanent certificate of insulation R-values, window U-factors, and equipment efficiencies and posts it near the furnace, in a utility room, or another approved interior location. As owner-builder, you are the builder.	You complete it; 2021 IECC R401.3

Forms that do not exist — stop looking for them

There is **no state building permit application**, because Colorado issues no state building permit. There is **no state owner-builder affidavit or exemption form** — the homeowner exemptions in C.R.S. 12-115-116(2) and 12-155-118(2) are self-executing in the statute, and the only "owner-builder form" you may meet is one your local building department invented. There is **no statewide submittal checklist** and **no statewide certificate of occupancy**. And in a county that has adopted no building code there is no building inspection record at all — which is exactly why the documents in this index matter. When a lender, insurer, or buyer asks for "the permit" on such a build, what you hand them is this stack: the certificates of approval, the OWTS acceptance, the well permit and construction report, and the utility's final release.

Sources (verified August 2026): the Division's published form set, listed separately for contractors and homeowners — dpo.colorado.gov/ElectricalPlumbingPermits/Forms. Permit-before-work and certificate-of-approval duties — C.R.S. 12-115-120(2)(b), (3)(a); 12-155-120(1)(c)(I), (2)(a); the inspection condition on the electrical exemption — 12-115-116(2). Well forms, the Beginner's Guide, the fee schedule, the 49-day review, and the permit search — dwr.colorado.gov. OWTS application content set by local rule and the final inspection before use — 25-10-106(1)(a), (1)(h). Local owner-builder terms — denvergov.org and pprbd.org, read August 2026. Energy certificate — 2021 IECC R401.3 as adopted.